B2 Listening

Understanding phone messages

Note the who, what and when from a voicemail, including the details people say only once.

Voicemail messages mix small talk with important details. Good listeners write down only what they will need: the caller, the reason, any numbers, and what they must do next.

Part of the message	Typical language
Who is calling	*Hi, it's Omar from… This is a message for…*
Why	*I'm calling about… I wanted to let you know that…*
Changes	*Unfortunately… We've had to move…*
What to do	*Could you call me back on… If you can't make it, just…*

Listen

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Hi, this is a message for Layla Hassan. It's Daniel from Brightway Dental Clinic. I'm calling about your appointment on Thursday the 14th at half past three. I'm afraid Dr Patel is away that afternoon, so we need to move it. We can offer you Friday the 15th at ten, or Monday the 18th at four fifteen. Could you call us back on 01632 960 482 to let us know which one suits you? If neither time works, just send us an email at bookings at brightway dental dot com. Thanks, and sorry for the inconvenience.

Write numbers in groups. Phone numbers are usually said in short groups of three to five digits. Write each group as you hear it, then check the total length.

Common mistake. Writing down the old appointment as the new one. Listen for *we need to move it* and the options after it.

Practice

1. Who is the message for?
2. Why does the clinic need to move the appointment?
3. What was the original day and time?
4. What two new times are offered?
5. What is the phone number?
6. What should Layla do if neither time works?

▼ **Show answers**

1. Layla Hassan
2. Dr Patel is away that afternoon.
3. Thursday the 14th at 3:30
4. Friday the 15th at 10:00, or Monday the 18th at 4:15
5. 01632 960 482
6. Send an email to bookings@brightwaydental.com.